real viewership is'. It was even translated into Punjabi for the audience in that state.

Two instances highlight the sheer energy of the Modi advertising blitz. The first was when Modi in mid-April went to file his nomination from Varanasi amidst massive crowds. The television images of the motorcade suggested a surge of support for him. Almost overnight, a fresh commercial with visuals from Varanasi and Modi's '*Ma Ganga ne bulaya hai'* sound bite was created. 'It was a powerful scene that had great recall value. The viewer could connect "achche din" to the euphoria around Modi,' is how a brand strategist describes it to me.

Pandey has an even better story to share. In early May, Modi took a sudden decision to hold a rally in Amethi, the bastion of the Gandhi family. Just two days before the rally, Pandey got a call from Goyal, saying Modi was keen that a film be created around Amethi's neglect. Pandey was in Goa with his ailing mother-in-law and said it would be difficult to get away. 'Please, Piyush, you have to do this for us. I will be forever obliged to you and I will owe your wife big time,' said Goyal. Within hours, the two Piyushes were flying off to Ahmedabad.

For the next twenty-four hours, Pandey and his creative partner from O&M, Rajkumar Jha, worked on putting together an Amethi film from a small studio in Ahmedabad. A camera team was sent to Amethi to get pictures of crater-like roads, and shanties. The pictures were uploaded via computer from Lucknow, a ninety-minute drive from Amethi. 'It was almost unreal. We were scripting, editing and recording in Ahmedabad, even as someone was shooting in Amethi and sending pictures from Lucknow!' says Pandey.

At 8 the next morning, a few hours before the evening rally, an eight-minute film was ready and flown off to Lucknow. The title of the film was *Amethi: Congress ke Liye Vote kee Peti* (Amethi: A Vote Bank for the Congress), and it was shown at the rally. 'It was the craziest twenty-four hours in my advertising career, but I loved it and felt twenty-five all over again!' says the fifty-nine-year-old with a glint in the eye.